

CAUSE AND EFFECT ON VARIOUS LEVELS OF CONSCIOUSNESS

My beloved friends, divine blessings are given to all of you, as this lecture is flowing forth into and through the human instrumentation. This blessing lasts. It stays and slowly awaits your readiness to come to its full flowering in you as you prepare the ground.

The topic of this lecture -- cause and effect -- is not an easy one to discuss on the three-dimensional level. Let me begin by saying that on the scale of development of consciousness, there is no cause and effect on the lowest level -- or there does not seem to be. Then, as consciousness raises itself, new connections appear in which effects are seen connected to causes that were previously apparently nonexistent. On the curve of development, when consciousness has become totally God-infused, there is no longer cause and effect.

As in so many other aspects in cosmic reality, the lowest and the highest seem to have certain common denominators. But what a difference, though, in content, attitude, and underlying thought and feeling. It is probably much easier for you to understand that the primitive consciousness sees the world in terms of unconnected, cause and effectless events than it is for you to understand that in the highest realm of being, cause and effect no longer exist. This is also the most difficult to describe in human language.

The sphere of your present reality makes every act weighty with its consequences. It may perhaps be more difficult to see the same relationship between thoughts, inner and more subtle attitudes on the one hand, and life circumstances on the other. So, right here, you can observe a graduation. The more developed a person is, the more he can perceive cause and effect on the more subtle levels. And on this path, this development is very strongly emphasized and becomes very apparent.

If you commit an overt act -- you kill someone -- the consequences will be obvious. But if your thoughts kill another human being by maligning him or her; by ill will; by accusations that may or may not be true as far as they go, but are never questioned; if there is no benefit of doubt given and no attempt made to create a different reality through honest exchange, this secret "killing" has just as definitive consequences as the physical killing. But they may not, at first, appear as obvious. Only as man progresses in his development and raises his consciousness is the connection between cause and effect made more apparent.

In your three-dimensional world, representing a certain state of consciousness, you find yourself "in the middle," as it were. This applies to many areas. Your world is neither all good, nor all bad. Your personality is neither all good, nor all bad. You neither live in a heaven, nor in a hell. You represent a combination of both extremes. This, incidentally, is such a clear indication for those who doubt that there are other worlds, other realms -- therefore other states of consciousness

-- that your sphere could not possibly be the only reality in the universe. For if some good exists in you and in your world, more degrees of goodness must exist. And finally all good must equally exist. The same applies to the bad: if there is a little bad in you and your world, there must also exist spheres of consciousness in which there is more and, finally, all bad.

You are also "in the middle" in regard to cause and effect -- or your perception of it. It is, of course, always a matter of your perception, for what you perceive does not change in itself. Your vision changes as you grow.

When you commit an act, it is irreversible. Its momentary consequences are irreversible. You may later modify this act. You may correct it if it was a mistake. You may use this act and what led to it within you as material to raise your consciousness and widen your vision and perception. You may thus, in time, wipe out the effects of a negative act. But at the moment, the act is irreversible. The consequences cannot be annulled. If consequences exist at the moment but can be eliminated in time, after a time, you can begin to glean that cause and effect is very much connected to time. Your state of development creates a corresponding reality. This reality contains three dimensions. It consists of time, space, and movement. It also contains the particular degree of cause and effect you can experience.

If you cannot see that your acts have specific consequences, it is impossible to use them as the most important tools for the development of your soul. For example, if you do not believe that a negative thought has specific and actually quite tangible results, how could you possibly be motivated to correct these thoughts? With time, correction can be undertaken, so that, again in time, the effect will be eliminated. By the same token, your life-affirming, truthful thoughts, attitudes, and actions inwardly or outwardly have correspondingly desirable effects. If you are unaware of the relationship between the cause and effect here but perceive the effects as coincidental and haphazard, you will not be encouraged and strengthened in the truth that love and goodness are the supreme power.

Let us say you are compelled by inner forces to commit an impulsive, destructive act. The pain and remorse that this act causes may be instantaneous. You long for a state of being in which you can undo this act, as if it never happened. Yet in the world you live in, this is impossible. How then can you understand what I said before that in higher realms there is no cause and effect? Perhaps you can sense deeply at certain times that "underneath" this level of cause and effect exists a level in which you are completely untouched by either the cause you have set in motion or by the effect you have brought about. That which is untouched by it is of course the higher self, the divine part of you that does not participate in any negative, destructive actions, thoughts, or attitudes and is therefore not effected by them. But those layers of personality that are still involved in false perceptions and therefore destructive, untruthful, and unloving acts (attitudes) must work themselves out of this morass. And this happens with time, in time. So cause and effect and time are intrinsically connected as different manifestations of the same reality.

You can perhaps also begin to perceive that the three-dimensional world with its limitation of time, space, and movement; duality; and cause and effect are all directly related to and connected with impurity, distortion, limitation of vision and perception, an untruthful world view. At the same time, time, space, and movement; the three dimensions; the struggle in regard to duality; and cause and effect become the very tools the soul needs in order to transcend this entire realm of

consciousness. Perception is the cause of certain actions which create certain effects, which in turn can be the medicine needed to overcome the causes creating these effects. Remember what I said to you before about cause, effect, and medicine.

In the highest state of consciousness there are only the highest, best, most creative and beautiful causes set in motion. In this enlightened state of consciousness, cause and effect are always immediately discernible -- so immediate in fact, that there is no longer "time" in between cause and effect. The cause is the effect. The thought is the act. The most subtle and secret attitude creates the immediate result and consequences. There is no space to travel in-between cause and effect so that they become truly One as all becomes One on this level of being. This is why you can sense, at certain times of grace, that somewhere deep within exists a realm of being in which no matter what happens, you remain unalterably pure, divine, and good in your essence. For your essence is the essence of All -- God.

Conversely, in the most primitive state of consciousness even the most obvious and overt act appears as an isolated thing without consequences or connections, without either cause or effect. The primitive person who commits murder may truly believe that his act has no further consequences, either for himself or for his victim. Nor will it occur to him to search for causes within himself that make him desire to commit this act. Therefore the act never becomes a medicine that will, in time, cure the disease of evil.

My beloved friends, it will be of great help and enlightenment for you to consider all this very deeply, to meditate about it and to profoundly take in these words, asking God for guidance and help that you may absorb them.

I would now like to discuss total surrender to God. You all battle with this central question or problem. The resistance to follow this call of your soul is exactly what causes all discomfort, pain, suffering, anxiety, and discontent. Surrender to God is an innate soul movement. It is your ultimate fate without which you can neither fulfill yourself nor can you fulfill your task. I wish to discuss this topic in connection with cause and effect. Surrender to God, or the lack of it, affects every conceivable aspect of your inner and outer life, but it is particularly enlightening in the framework of this lecture.

Let us now consider some natural effects of total surrender to God. Since this is a natural, innate soul movement, it means fulfilling one's destiny. It brings about a balance and harmony in the entire organism. In the mental organism, truthful perception, clarity of vision, and realistic understanding reign. Thus a great harmony and peace of mind exist. Conflicting perceptions, confusions, and therefore frustration, are wiped out. Enlightenment and insight into apparent conflicts make all the pieces of the great puzzle of life fall into place.

On the emotional level, this mental clarification of opposites creates an entirely new mode of being, of reacting, of feeling. For example, loving no longer appears weakening and humiliating. On the contrary, it creates healthy pride and dignity. Surrender to God avoids one of the greatest pitfalls of human kind: surrender to superior negative power structures. The moment the natural soul movement, man's innate destiny -- to surrender to God -- is obstructed and resisted against, substitute, false surrender must follow suit. My friends, this is important to understand.

If you fear a human authority, whether this authority really abuses power or if you only imagine it does so, hardly matters; it is because you depend on this authority in some tangible or intangible way. You may then respond to this dependence and fear by either submitting or selling out and hating yourself for it. Or you may respond by blind rebellion against this authority, in order to avoid this self-hatred and preserve your dignity. But this is not real dignity, it is merely a blind reaction, based on emotional reflexes and turbulent feelings that you are mostly unaware of. In both instances, you are not clear about the issues, you do not really distinguish, you lack the true insight whether or not the authority is indeed abusive or whether you react like a child.

If your total surrender to God is a genuine, all encompassing fact, you will perceive with utter clarity if a person who has power over you is unworthy of this power and tries to subdue you, abuse, or exploit you or trample your human dignity. If this person is a boss on whom you are financially dependent or if this person is a mate whose love you crave for and need; if your surrender to God is your primary position in life, your main emphasis and attitude, you will trust God and know that this trust is utterly justified so that you can find the courage to risk loss of the thing you need. By setting God ahead of all else, your vision will make it very clear when human authority is abusive, so that you can then choose to pay the price. You will give up what this authority holds out for you because your dignity and inner freedom are more important. Your autonomy can only grow out of total surrender to God.

The further consequences of this attitude will be that you must soon find another situation in which you can fulfill your real needs without enslavement of your soul. A new boss or a new mate will also be autonomous people whose inner soul movement follow the call to set God ahead of all else. In this case they will not need to abuse their power, power invested in them by virtue of other people's needs. Or you may even find that these very same people will react differently. They also battle between their higher and their lower self attitudes. They may set you inwardly free and respect your dignity so that the relationship between you and them becomes a mutual giving and receiving in whatever this may imply.

If your perception is distorted and you assume only that authority humiliates and abuses you, your total surrender to God will clarify this, and your vision and perception will adjust to reality. Thus you will no longer be called upon to rebel against a rightful authority who merely expects your rightful part in the mutual venture. Rebellion against an alleged abusive authority often masks your own hidden desire to have power over others and to abuse this power. You may never think of it in this manner, in these exact words. But when your self-will becomes an imperative in your life, when not being able to have your self-will fulfilled creates strong feelings of humiliation and powerlessness in you, then you believe you must either be the greatest power in your universe -- God -- or you must go under. In order to avoid going under, you may then tend to submit to substitute powers, not to God power. It may be the power of another stronger or seemingly stronger person, dictator, leader. By serving him, you hope to gain this superior position yourself. Or it may be the power of money or position, which then become substitutes for God. Or it may be the power of staying aloof from others, never opening fully your own heart, but making yourself needed by their neurotic needs.

Submission to substitute powers and authority, as well as rebellion against any kind of authority, are both results or effects of the cause that is set in motion when the natural soul movement to surrender to God is being obstructed. When God is set first, it all falls into place.

When this is not the case, you must be confused about the authority you need and serve; you must be confused about when self-assertion and when following the lead are appropriate. When surrender to God is your primary position, you are clearly aware what is what, and you can then follow suit in your action without inner conflict. You will admit that you have needs; that in certain areas of your life an authority or leader is necessary; that you have a role to play in this relationship, and in this way you only heighten your selfhood and true dignity. By following this leader, you can never lose your soul because your soul belongs to God who returns it to you stronger, cleaner, and more autonomous than ever.

Resistance to your destiny to surrender all of yourself to God and His will for you must create a real and permeating and weakening guilt. So much of your weakness, hesitancy, self-doubt, and self-punishing patterns are a direct result of this. No matter how many psychological explanations you may find -- and they may be true on their level as far as they go -- this self-defeating pattern can never be reversed and transformed unless you heal yourself spiritually by giving over all of yourself in all areas of your life and in all respects to the Creator.

When this happens -- and of course it is not a one time act, but one that needs to be repeated daily and in all issues of your life -- you will suddenly experience a new strength and sense of self that you never knew before. This will appear almost paradoxical. Deep down you always feared that by giving over to God you will lose yourself, and now you find, as palpable reality, that Jesus' words are true: you must lose yourself -- in God -- in order to find yourself.

This new strength will suddenly become a spontaneous movement. The wisdom to choose when to use positive aggression and when to give in gracefully will be an almost instantaneous knowing, out of which the appropriate act will flow. The positive, energetic, aggressive movement will replace childish and destructive rebellion and denial. Graceful giving in, yielding, following, accepting even when your self-will may not like it will replace humiliation, self-denial, submission out of fear, and distrust of life. In both instances you may choose in new ways. Where you would formerly have submitted weakly, you may now follow and yield with your dignity in place. Or you may find that positive aggression is in place. Where you would formerly have blindly and destructively rebelled, you may now also stand up, but in a new spirit, out of different motives, with a clearer vision and knowledge. It will thus have an entirely different effect on others and yourself. The tenor of your aggression will be different. Or you may come to see that this situation requires not fighting, but giving in; that this is fair, right, necessary, justified and good for all concerned; and that there was no injustice or abuse involved that would require your aggression.

But positive aggression is necessary not only in order to rebuke injustice and abuse. It is not merely a responsive action, it must also be an initial action. This kind of positive aggression is necessary to move out, to expand, to improve, to create -- whether within yourself or in your environment. No negative inner material can be transformed without this energetic movement surging forth. When this movement surges forth in a healthy, organic way, it is neither depleting nor effortful. It is a release and a liberation that energizes the entire organism. But this is only the case when it is the appropriate, organic aggression that is in accordance with God's will. The new positive reality you all strive to create can come to pass only when you are free from the confusions that inevitably arise as a result of denying your soul movement, your inner call to give over to God. You will no longer have to ask when you should stand up and assert yourself and when you should give in and follow. You will no longer doubt the nature of a human authority or person you depend

upon and need nor his or her motives. You will not have to grapple with your intellect only, which could never give you this insight. You will know spontaneously. The knowledge will be there in front of you, clear and strong, without a doubt. You will flow out of the center of your being, where God reigns, where Christ is king, and where all is right with you, your actions, your perceptions, your knowledge, your reactions, and your feelings. The peace and one-pointedness that you long for lies in this key, my beloved friends. Use this key.

We hope that this lecture will have brought you a step nearer to making your surrender to God your primary goal. Your entire life will change in the sense I discussed and also in many other ways I could not possibly go into in this lecture but will touch on in the future. You thus set a new cause in motion that will bring new effects. Many of your life circumstances now that you do not like are the result or effect of holding back in trusting God and giving over to Him. You may have done so in some respects of your life -- thus the effects are desirable and joyous. The cause creates commensurate effects. But your soul is divided. There are many areas in which this may not as yet have happened. It is there that you need to change your fundamental relationship to your Creator. Where you have fear, insecurity, anxiety, self-doubt, conflict with others, altercations with your environment, or any kind of unfulfillment or frustration, there must be the underlying cause in which you deny the call of your soul. Use this clear and simple gauge.

My beloved friends, the blessings extended to all of you are specifically directed at this time toward helping you to realize this giving over to Him who holds you, who contains you, who makes you safe and secure, who infuses His truth and His love into all your being so that you become an instrumentation for Him. Be blessed.

For information to find and participate in Pathwork activities world wide, please write:

The Pathwork® Foundation
PO Box 6010
Charlottesville, VA 22906-6010, USA
Call: 1-800-PATHWORK, or
Visit: www.pathwork.org

The following notices are for your guidance in the use of the Pathwork® name and this lecture material.

Trademark/Service Mark

Pathwork® is a registered service mark owned by The Pathwork Foundation, and may not be used without the express written permission of the Foundation. The Foundation may, in its sole discretion, authorize use of the Pathwork® mark by other organizations or persons, such as affiliate organizations and chapters.

Copyright

The copyright of the Pathwork Guide material is the sole property of The Pathwork Foundation. This lecture may be reproduced, in compliance with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy, but the text may not be altered or abbreviated in any way, nor may the copyright, trademark, service mark, or any other notices be removed. Recipients may be charged the cost of reproduction and distribution only.

Any person or organization using The Pathwork Foundation service mark or copyrighted material is deemed to have agreed to comply with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy. To obtain information or a copy of this policy, please contact the Foundation.